Blameless Incident Review

Learn from an incident without blame: what happened, why it made sense at the time, and how to make it less likely.

Improve · Blameless Post-Incident Review · Learning from Incidents · Systems, Not People

INCIDENT _____

REVIEW DATE _____

1 Summary

FACTS ONLY

What happened: _____ Detected by / how: _____

Impact (who, how long): _____ Duration to recover: _____

Severity: ☐ 1 · critical ☐ 2 · major ☐ 3 · minor ☐ 4 · near miss

2 Ground Rules

READ ALOUD AT THE START

- ☐ We look at systems, not at who to blame
- ☐ People did what made sense with what they knew
- ☐ Curiosity over judgement: ask “how”, not “who”
- ☐ What we learn is shared openly

3 Timeline

WHAT DID PEOPLE KNOW AT EACH POINT?

TIME	WHAT HAPPENED	WHAT WE KNEW THEN	WHAT WE DID AND WHY

4 Contributing Factors

USUALLY SEVERAL · RARELY ONE ROOT CAUSE

Technology

Stickies

Process

Stickies

Knowledge

Stickies

Environment

Stickies

Communication

Stickies

5 What Helped

Stickies

6 Where We Got Lucky

Stickies

7 Follow-up Actions

PREVENT · DETECT SOONER · RECOVER FASTER

ACTION	TYPE: PREVENT / DETECT / RECOVER	OWNER	DUE

“Why did it make sense to them at the time?”

“What would make the next incident less likely, or easier to recover from?”

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